

Warm Escapes Seasonal Calendar

Cymbal Voyages Brand Studio · Agency onboarding packet · Last updated September 2026

Warm escapes are our signature category: winter and early-spring getaways to the Caribbean, Mexico, Hawaii, Central America and the Florida Keys, booked mostly by customers in the eight cold-weather markets. The booking season runs August through January and travel runs December through April. The calendar below runs July through April because our year begins when the first planning starts, a month before the first bookings. Every warm-escape brief should place itself on this calendar and say which month's job it is doing.

Month by month

Month	What we do	Why
July	Refresh destination pages and imagery, finalize inventory and "from" prices with suppliers, build the season's creative. Confirm the Warm Escapes Retargeting (CMP-002) budget and audience.	Nothing is booked yet, and everything we publish from August on depends on prices and photography being right.
August	Retargeting turns on in cold-weather markets. Silver and Gold members get early access to inventory. The first organic warm-escapes content publishes. Propensity scores start to move.	The first cold mornings arrive in Minneapolis and Denver in late August. Customers begin browsing before they are ready to book, and retargeting catches that browsing.
September	The main win-back window. Winter Sun Early Bird (CMP-003 in 2025) launches to lapsed members with bonus points, beach-couple imagery and Plan your escape. Retargeting runs at full seasonal weight.	Lapsed members have the highest propensity of the year in September, and December inventory is still wide open, so bonus points buy a full-price booking rather than a discounted one.
October	Early-bird offers close on October 31, stated once. Retargeting continues. Email shifts from "welcome back" to "what is still open for December."	The deadline gives the season a shape without a countdown. October is the peak month for December and January departures.
November	Retargeting continues through the month. Holiday Gift of Travel (CMP-004 in 2025) runs from mid-November with family-pool imagery and gift framing across all customers.	Family-pool imagery outperforms everything else in this window, which we attribute to the season rather than the segment. Gift bookings fill February and March.
December	Holiday campaign closes December 24. Warm-escape messaging pauses in the last week; confirmations and pre-trip email take over for the December travelers.	Customers are travelling or hosting. Media spent in the last week of December converts poorly, and the first travelers of the season deserve our attention.
January	Booking season ends. Last-Minute Warm Deals (CMP-011 in 2026) opens on about January 20 with free-night framing on unsold February departures to active members in cold and mild markets.	Free-night offers read as generous without teaching customers to wait for a discount. January is the coldest month in every market we serve and the month with the most remaining inventory.
February	Last-minute program runs to February 28. Ski (CMP-005) and cruise wave season (CMP-007) take the paid budget. Warm-escape travel peaks.	February departures are the last to clear. Pre-trip and in-trip email carries the relationship for the season's travelers.
March	Warm-escape travel continues; booking activity tails off. No sitewide sales to members (CMP-006 in 2026 taught us that). City-break and cruise categories carry the paid plan.	March is a soft month for bookings and the wrong month to discount to members. Post-trip email invites reviews and sets up next season.
April	Season closes. Retrospectives are written, the post-season member survey goes out,	The record of what worked has to be complete before July, when the next

	and next year's supplier conversations begin.	year's planning starts.
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The backbone: always-on retargeting

The Warm Escapes Retargeting program (CMP-002) is the backbone of August through November. It is paid social, in cold-weather markets only, to `lapsed_compass_cold` members who browsed a warm destination but did not book, at a base of \$3,000 a day with seasonal multipliers that peak in these months. It has historically been our most efficient always-on program, because it reaches people who have already told us what they want. Every seasonal campaign in the table above is built on the assumption that retargeting is running underneath it.

As of this update, that assumption does not hold. CMP-002's paid-social budget was rotated to Fall City Breaks (CMP-012) from July 24, 2026 and has not been restored, and warm-escape bookings in August 2026 came in under plan. Whether the two are connected is an open question for the fall planning review, and any warm-escape brief written before that review should state plainly whether retargeting is live.